VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

PROJECT REPORT

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

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Introduction

This project report documents my work as part of the Digital Literacy course (CSE0001) at VIT Bhopal University. The project is built around a scenario in which I have been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador — a role that involves helping fellow students navigate the digital world responsibly and effectively. To fulfil this role, I was required to complete five structured tasks, each aligned with a specific module of the course.

The tasks cover a wide spectrum of digital skills: creating an awareness infographic, building a professional online portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional email communication, and conducting a cybercrime awareness study. All work is organised in a single GitHub repository, which itself forms part of the submission. This report provides a written account of each task, including the tools used, the work produced, and personal reflections on what I learned from each activity.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a one-page infographic aimed at helping my batchmates understand the core concepts of Digital Literacy. I chose Canva as my design tool because of its intuitive drag-and-drop interface and wide selection of free templates suited for educational content. The infographic covers three key topics: what digital literacy means in a student context, safe internet practices including password hygiene and phishing awareness, and tips for building a professional online presence on platforms such as LinkedIn and GitHub.

Designing the infographic was an engaging experience. I used a clean two-column layout with icons, colour-coded sections, and concise bullet points to ensure the content was easy to read at a glance. One aspect I found challenging was maintaining visual balance — fitting all three topics onto a single page without making it look cluttered required several rounds of revision. What I found most interesting was discovering how much thought goes into visual communication: the choice of font, colour, and icon all influence how information is received. This task gave me a genuine appreciation for design thinking as a skill in its own right. The final infographic has been exported as a PNG and added to the task-1-presentation/ folder of my repository.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. GitHub is a version control and code-hosting platform widely used by developers, researchers, and students to collaborate on projects and showcase their work. I created a profile README on GitHub — a special repository named after my username — which includes my name, registration number, branch, and a brief statement about my learning goals in AI and machine learning. LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform, used by employers, internship coordinators, and academics. I filled in my Education section with details of my B.Tech programme at VIT Bhopal University, including my expected graduation year. Kaggle is a data science community platform that hosts datasets, competitions, and learning notebooks directly relevant to my AI/ML specialisation.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as a living portfolio — gradually populating it with projects, assignments, and open-source contributions. LinkedIn will be used to connect with professionals, track internship opportunities, and document certifications and achievements as I progress through my degree. Kaggle will serve as a practical learning environment where I can participate in beginner competitions and explore datasets related to AI. Setting up these profiles early has made me realise that a professional digital identity is something that needs to be built incrementally and maintained consistently. Screenshots of all three profiles have been added to the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

Task 3: Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Task 3 was divided into two parts. For Part A, I created an account on HackerRank and completed the 'Solve Me First' beginner challenge, which introduced me to the platform's problem submission interface and the basic format of competitive programming questions. The challenge involved writing a simple function to return the sum of two integers — a straightforward task, but a useful introduction to reading problem statements carefully and submitting code for automated evaluation. I also attempted the Python Introduction challenge to familiarise myself with Python syntax in a structured online environment.

For Part B, I created a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz includes multiple choice questions on topics such as identifying phishing emails and safe password practices, as well as a short-answer question asking respondents to describe one habit that makes them more secure online. I linked the form responses to a Google Sheet, enabling automatic data collection. Both a screenshot of the form and the linked response sheet have been added to task-3-platforms/. These tools will be directly useful in my academic journey: HackerRank for practising coding problems ahead of placement assessments, and Google Workspace for collaborative assignments, data collection, and group project coordination throughout my degree.

Task 4: Professional Email Etiquette

Task 4 required me to draft two professional emails and produce a social media checklist. The email-writing exercise was a valuable reminder that digital communication carries real consequences. A scenario that illustrates this clearly is the widely reported case of a job applicant who sent a casual, poorly formatted follow-up email to a recruiter — the recruiter shared it on social media, and the applicant's prospects were effectively ended before an interview could take place. The core problem was a failure to match tone and format to context: informal language that is perfectly acceptable among friends is inappropriate in a professional setting.

Had the applicant used a clear subject line, a formal salutation, a concise and well-structured body, and a proper sign-off, the outcome would almost certainly have been different. This task reinforced that professional email writing is a learnable skill, not an innate talent. Key learnings include: always using a specific and informative subject line; opening with the recipient's correct title and name; keeping the body focused and free of abbreviations or slang; and closing with a formal sign-off. Both email drafts and the social media checklist have been saved inside task-4-email-etiquette/.

Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist:

DO's ✅	**DON'Ts ❌**
Keep profiles professional and up to date	Don't share personal details publicly (address, phone)
Think before you post — content is permanent	Don't engage in or share cyberbullying content
Use strong, unique passwords for each platform	Don't accept requests from unknown accounts
Report harmful or abusive content promptly	Don't share unverified news or misinformation
Review privacy settings regularly	Don't complain about professors or employers publicly

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness – UPI and Online Payment Fraud

For Task 5, I chose UPI and online payment fraud as my cybercrime topic, as it is highly relevant to college students in India who routinely use apps such as PhonePe, Google Pay, and Paytm for everyday transactions. My research revealed that fraudsters typically impersonate bank officials or customer support agents, creating a false sense of urgency — for example, claiming that a UPI account will be blocked unless the victim immediately shares their PIN or clicks a link. Victims are then told to 'receive' money by entering their PIN, not realising that entering a PIN always authorises a payment outward rather than receiving one inward.

What surprised me most was how technically simple these attacks are — they require no sophisticated hacking skills, only social engineering and the exploitation of trust. This changed my perspective on cybersecurity: it is not purely a technical problem but a behavioural one. The one habit I will personally change is never sharing any OTP, UPI PIN, or account detail over a phone call or message, regardless of how official or urgent the request appears. I have also saved the National Cyber Crime Helpline number (1930) and the reporting portal cybercrime.gov.in so I know exactly where to turn if I or anyone I know is targeted. The full case study and prevention checklist are saved in task-5-cybercrime/.

Conclusion

This project has been a genuinely useful introduction to the digital landscape I will navigate throughout my academic and professional life. Across five tasks, I developed skills in content creation, professional self-presentation, coding platform familiarity, formal communication, and online safety awareness. The most important insight I take away is that digital literacy is not a single skill but a continuous practice — one that requires critical thinking, deliberate habit formation, and a willingness to keep learning as technology evolves. My GitHub repository now serves as the foundation of a portfolio I intend to build and maintain throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal University.

References

- Canva Design Tool – canva.com
- GitHub – github.com
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Forms / Google Workspace – forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- National Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930 (24x7)
- VIT Bhopal University – CSE0001 Digital Literacy Project Assignment Brief (2026)